

BLACK TEMPLARS — TEMPLAR BASTION RUNBOOK

*Lone Star Open (LSO) — 300+ players, Swiss
Generated 2026-07-27 (11E, post-Dataslate)*

Version 1.0 · 2026-07-27

THE LIST

Detachments: Bastion Task Force (3 DP) — the generic SM defensive/auspex detachment, run with BT units + Templar Vows

Disposition: Take and Hold — a hold-the-line brick army. It scores by HOLDING objectives and grinds the enemy down under stacked debuffs; it does not alpha or deliver.

Points: 1,995 / 2000 (the friend's build). EC 105 = base + Blades of Valour; Marshal 100 = base + Hero of the Chapter. Points are the app's (v912). Legality of the key tech verified: Hero of the Chapter grants BATTLELINE (Sword Brethren -> Battleline), Marshal & EC & Grimaldus & Lieutenant all legally lead their bricks, Combi-Lieutenant is a Lone Operative. Templar Vow = Accept Any Challenge.

A BLACK TEMPLARS HOLD-AND-GRIND CONTROL army — the opposite of the delivered-spike list. Lots of durable BATTLELINE bricks push onto objectives, generate AUSPEX SCANS, and the whole army re-rolls into the scanned target while the debuff toolkit (pin -2M/-2 charge, suppress -1 hit) blunts the enemy. Its removal is RELIABLE and needs no delivery: two Repulsor Executioners with INTERCEPTION STRIKE (full Hit re-rolls vs anything near your line) do the ranged work, and a crit-on-5 Lethal-Hits Sword Brethren brick (Marshal + Castellan, made Battleline by Hero of the Chapter) is the melee that cracks vehicles/monsters in the fight phase. Grimaldus's relic-buffed 20-Crusader anvil holds the middle; the Emperor's Champion is a Precision character-assassin; a Lone-Operative Combi-Lieutenant limpets a key objective. The Templar Vow (Accept Any Challenge) gives +1 to Wound when wounding UP, so the melee bites into tough targets. Durable + reliable + few bad matchups — its whole game is out-lasting and out-scoring, and its only real holes are being SLOW (a fast/kiting gun army out-manoeuvers it) and getting OUT-BODIED by a true horde.

- **1x Emperor's Champion + Blades of Valour (105) — WARLORD.** Leads the 10 Assault Intercessors. Black Sword S8 AP-3->AP-4 D3 A6 [ANTI-CHARACTER 5+, PRECISION] -> character-assassin. Blades of Valour = +1 AP melee for his Battleline unit (chainswords AP-1->AP-2).
- **10x Assault Intercessor Squad (150) — Bodyguard (Battleline).** AP-2 chainswords (Blades of Valour), auspex-scan generator, advance-and-charge (Interlocking Tactics). Mobile scanning melee brick + the EC.
- **1x Chaplain Grimaldus (+3 Cenobyte) (100) —** Leads the 20-Crusader anvil. Litanies = re-roll ALL melee Hits (unit); Temple Relics (Command phase, default +1 AP / alt +1 T / +1 Adv&Charge). FNP 5+ on HIM + Cenobytes only.

- **1x Lieutenant (Support) (45)** — Stacks into the Crusader anvil — a support wound-buff character.
- **20x Crusader Squad (290)** — Bodyguard (Battleline). THE ANVIL: 20 bodies, 4 power fists (S8 AP-2->AP-3 w/ relic) + master-crafted power weapon. Re-roll all melee Hits (Grimaldus), +1 AP relic, Angels Defiant (-1 to wound). Sticky, hard to shift.
- **1x Marshal + Hero of the Chapter (100)** — Leads the Sword Brethren. INSPIRATIONAL EXEMPLAR: unmodified Hit of 5+ = Critical Hit. HERO OF THE CHAPTER: the Marshal gains BATTLELINE -> the whole Sword Brethren brick counts as Battleline (unlocks Interlocking Tactics + Bastion strats for it).
- **1x Castellan (Support) (70)** — Stacks into the Sword Brethren. VEHEMENT AGGRESSION: re-roll Hits -> more 5+ crits to convert via Lethal Hits.
- **10x Sword Brethren Squad (260)** — Bodyguard. THE HAMMER: 6 master-crafted power weapons [LETHAL HITS] + 2 thunder hammers (S8 [DEV]) + 2 twin lightning claws. With crit-on-5 + re-rolls + Accept vow (+1 wound up), it deletes vehicles/monsters IN MELEE (no invuln vs Questoris/Dominus). Battleline via Hero of the Chapter -> Light of Vengeance adds Sustained.
- **1x Lieutenant with Combi-weapon (95)** — LONE OPERATIVE + FNP 5+. Priority Objective Identified: nominate 1 objective -> the whole army re-rolls Wound-1s vs enemies near it. Evade and Survive: a REACTIVE move (Normal move in the enemy's turn when they end a move within 9"). A near-unkillable objective limpet.
- **5x Intercessor Squad (80)** — Battleline objective holder + scanner; advance-and-shoot (Interlocking Tactics).
- **5x Assault Intercessors w/ Jump Packs (85)** — Battleline, deep-strike + advance-and-charge -> a mobile scanner / objective-grabber (x2 in the list).
- **5x Assault Intercessors w/ Jump Packs (85)** — 2nd jump squad — reserve pressure / late-objective flex.
- **1x Repulsor Executioner (265)** — The gun: Heavy Laser Destroyer (S16 AP-4 D6+4) AT + Heavy Onslaught Gatling (A12 [Dev]) anti-infantry + multi-melta. INTERCEPTION STRIKE = full Hit re-roll vs anything within 12" of a friendly unit. Reliable removal, every turn.
- **1x Repulsor Executioner (265)** — 2nd gun platform (2nd Heavy Laser Destroyer + gatling). Two Interception-Strike RepExes = the army's dependable damage.

THE TAPESTRY — how it wins

- **Templar Vows — ACCEPT ANY CHALLENGE (the army rule; NOT Oath)** — BT don't get Oath of Moment; they pick ONE Templar Vow army-wide. Default = Accept Any Challenge: each melee attack where the attacker's S <= the target's T gets +1 to Wound. It helps you wound UP into tough things (vehicles/monsters/elites) — exactly where the melee bricks need help. Switch to Uphold the Honour (INFANTRY sticky objectives) only vs a majority-T3 army (where S>T means Accept does nothing).
- **Interlocking Tactics (detachment rule) + AUSPEX** — BATTLELINE units can Advance/Fall Back and still shoot + declare a charge (+ do Actions). And whenever a Battleline unit attacks, pick one enemy unit it hit -> it's AUSPEX SCANNED; every model in your army re-rolls Hit rolls of 1 vs a scanned target.

That's your army-wide accuracy engine (this list's substitute for Oath) + the mobility that lets the bricks reposition.

- **Interception Strike — the RELIABLE guns (Repulsor Executioner) —** BT datasheet rule: each RepEx re-rolls ALL Hit rolls when it targets a unit within 12" of a friendly Astartes unit — in a brick army that's basically always on. So both Heavy Laser Destroyers (S16 AP-4 D6+4) + gatlings + multi-meltas fire re-rolling every turn: dependable ranged AT + anti-infantry with NO delivery risk. This is why the list is consistent.
- **The Sword Brethren HAMMER (crit-5 Lethal, made Battleline) —** Marshal (INSPIRATIONAL EXEMPLAR: unmodified Hit 5+ = Critical Hit) + Sword Brethren power weapons [LETHAL HITS] (crit -> auto-wound) + Castellan (VEHEMENT AGGRESSION re-roll) + Accept vow (+1 wound up) + 2 thunder hammers (S8 Dev). Hero of the Chapter makes it BATTLELINE, so LIGHT OF VENGEANCE (1CP) can bolt [SUSTAINED HITS 1] on top -> more crit-5s -> more auto-wounds. It cracks vehicles/monsters IN MELEE (Questoris/Dominus have no melee invuln). NOTE: no Slayers +2S here — that's Marshal's Household, a different detachment.
- **Grimaldus — the relic anvil (no unit FNP) —** Litanies of the Devout: the led unit re-rolls ALL melee Hits. Temple Relics (each Command phase, needs the Cenobytes): default WATER FROM THE STOUP = +1 AP for the unit's melee (power fists AP-2->AP-3, chainswords AP-1->AP-2); alts COLUMN = +1 Toughness (defensive pivot), BANNER = +1 Advance & Charge. FNP 5+ is Grimaldus + Cenobytes ONLY — the brick's durability is bodies + the relic + Angels Defiant, not FNP.
- **The debuff / control toolkit (Bastion stratagems) —** Layer onto the auspex scan: GUIDED DISRUPTION (pin: -2" Move, -2 Charge), SHOCK BOMBARDMENT (suppress: -1 to Hit), CODEX DISCIPLINE (re-roll Hits, +Wound-1s vs scanned), LIGHT OF VENGEANCE (Lethal or Sustained vs scanned), ANGELS DEFIANT (a Battleline unit gets -1 to Wound vs attacks where S>T -> the key defensive tech), HERESY UNDONE (a non-Battleline unit advance+charge). ~1 strat/turn (CP-limited); pick the priority.
- **The Emperor's Champion — the scalpel —** Black Sword S8 AP-3 (AP-4 with Blades of Valour) D3 A6 [ANTI-CHARACTER 5+, PRECISION]. He alone picks out and kills an attached enemy Character in melee (Sigismund's Heir re-rolls a charge to reach a Character within 12"). Save him for the enemy's key buff-character.
- **The Combi-Lieutenant — the objective limpet —** LONE OPERATIVE (can't be shot >12") + FNP 5+ + Priority Objective (army re-rolls Wound-1s vs enemies near his nominated objective) + Evade and Survive (a REACTIVE Normal move in the enemy's turn when a unit ends a move within 9"). Nearly impossible to shift; anchors a corner and buffs the army's wounding there.
- **What this list genuinely can't do —** (1) CATCH a fast/kiting gun army — everything is M6 foot bricks (advance-and-charge helps, but a Drukhari or a shooting-Knight list out-maneuvres and shoots it off); (2) out-BODY a true horde (Orks) on primary. It's durable and reliable, so it has few bad matchups — but it wins the LONG game, not the tempo game.

Mindset

Play it as a patient CONTROL grinder, not a race. The plan: hold objectives with durable Battleline bricks, auspex-scan whatever's in front of you so the whole army re-rolls into it, and stack the debuffs (pin the melee threats off you, suppress the shooters) while the Interception-Strike RepExes and the crit-5 Sword Brethren delete the priority piece. Three disciplines: (1) DON'T over-extend the bricks — you win by holding and out-lasting, so make the enemy come to you and grind them under -1-to-wound (Angels Defiant) + the +1 T/AP relic; (2) SPEND the debuff strats on the thing that decides the turn (pin the charge that would break a brick, suppress the alpha); (3) use the EC + Combi-Lieutenant as scalpels — assassinate a key character, limpet a key objective. Accept the two bad matchups (fast kiting gun lists, true hordes) and grind everyone else.

Realistic record

Templar Bastion is a STRONG, CONSISTENT hold-and-grind list — ~55% prevalence-weighted, and notably more reliable than the delivered-spike BT build because its removal (Interception guns) needs no delivery and its durability (Angels Defiant + relic + bodies) has few bad matchups. Realistic 300+ GT: a solidly positive record with a high floor — it rarely gets blown out. It wins by DURABILITY + RELIABLE REMOVAL + auspex control, holding primary and grinding the enemy under debuffs. Its ceiling is capped by ONE axis: SPEED. Everything is M6 foot bricks, so a fast/kiting gun army (Drukhari in the meta; a shooting-dominant Knight list off-meta) out-manoevres it and plays the objectives it can't reach — and a true horde (Orks) out-bodies it. Against everything that stands and fights, it grinds them down. A genuine tournament list, not a gimmick.

FAVOURABLE (bank these): Emperor's Children, AdMech, Astra Militarum, Blood Angels

COIN-FLIP (practice these): Custodes (lean fav), Dark Angels (lean fav), T'au Retaliation, Necrons C'tan

UNFAVOURABLE (underdog): Drukhari Skysplinter (speed), Orks Green Tide (bodies)

STRUCTURAL BOGEY (off-meta): Shooting-dominant Knights that KITE the slow bricks — same axis as Drukhari

SIM VERIFICATION (data-driven)

Games/archetype via tools/mc_bt_bastion_sim.py. Guns = the reliable Interception-Strike package (2 Repulsor Executioners, full hit re-rolls) onto the priority target; Melee = the crit-5 Sword Brethren brick (Accept vow, no delivery risk). Durable hold-and-grind — indicative; coin-flips are the matchups to practise.

Archetype	Prev.	Verdict	Guns	Melee	BT win%
Emperor's Children (Defiler+s warm)	9	FAV	26	22	76%
Orks (Green Tide horde)	8	UNFAV	12	43	22%
AdMech (Rad-Zone gunline)	6	FAV	53	26	69%
T'au (Retaliation alpha)	5	COIN	21	19	53%
Necrons (Awakened C'tan)	4	COIN	20	17	45%
Custodes (elite melee)	4	COIN	5	20	60%
Blood Angels (jump alpha)	4	FAV	7	31	63%
Dark Angels (Deathwing)	3	COIN	5	23	64%
Drukhari (Skysplinter)	3	UNFAV	35	26	34%
Astra Militarum (superheavy)	2	FAV	33	17	69%

Prevalence-weighted BT-Bastion win rate $\approx 55\%$ — a strong, CONSISTENT hold-and-grind list (reliable removal + durability = few bad matchups). Capped by SPEED: loses to fast/kiting gun lists and true hordes; grinds everything that stands and fights.

BATTLE PLANS

Emperor's Children — Frenzied Host / Coterie (Defiler + swarm)

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: High (9)*

Deciding factor: You out-durable and out-grind the paper swarm: the +1 T/-1-to-wound bricks eat the Infractor/Daemonette melee, Interception guns delete a Defiler/turn (their only real anti-armour), and the crit-5 Sword Brethren + Accept vow crush the elites. Their AP-1/-2 volume is the wrong shape for your armour.

Game plan:

- Interception RepExes delete a Defiler each turn; pin/suppress the Infractors off your line.
- Let the chaff break on the Grimaldus anvil (re-roll hits + relic + Angels Defiant); Sword Brethren counter-punch.
- EC Precision-kills a Lord Exultant/buff-char; hold primary and grind — they can't out-durable or out-score you.

Watch for: Fulgrim (Fights First) can trade into a brick before it swings — pin him (-2 charge) or bait him onto the anvil first.

Orks — Green Tide (~100 bodies)

UNFAVOURABLE (your hardest common matchup) · *Prevalence: High (8)*

Deciding factor: The one thing that beats a durable brick army: raw BODIES. ~100 Boyz out-score your holders on primary, and the flood blankets objectives your M6 bricks can't all cover. Your gatlings + Sword Brethren mow Boyz in bulk, but you can't clear 100 or out-body the tide.

Game plan:

- Gatlings (A12 Dev, Interception re-rolls) + Sword Brethren + anvil mow Boyz; suppress the klaw-nob brick that cracks your armour.
- Hold 2-3 objectives hard (relic +1T anvil), concede the middle; the Combi-Lieutenant limpets a corner.
- Interception guns delete the Kill Rig/Stompa; race secondaries — you won't win the primary body-count.

Watch for: Getting out-actioned and out-bodied. Honest ~22% — minimise the margin, don't chase kills.

Adeptus Mechanicus — Rad-Zone / Lords of the Forge gunline

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: High (6)*

Deciding factor: Their D6-damage anti-tank OVER-kills your bodies (waste) and Angels Defiant blunts the rest, while your Interception guns + Sword Brethren delete a Kataphron brick/turn and you out-body their low-model gunline. Advance-and-charge (Interlocking Tactics) closes the distance and their line folds in melee.

Game plan:

- Interception RepExes delete a Kataphron brick each turn; suppress/pin the shooters (-1 hit, -2 move).
- Advance the Battleline bricks into the gunline (few melee bodies); Sword Brethren + power-fist Crusaders carve it.
- Out-score — hold with bodies once their shooting is tar-pitted in melee.

Watch for: Culexus/Callidus sniping your buff characters (Marshal/Grimaldus) — screen them with the bricks.

T'au Empire — Retaliation Cadre (fusion/rail alpha)

COIN-FLIP · *Prevalence: High (5)*

Deciding factor: This is where Bastion shines vs a melee list: you SURVIVE the alpha (2+ saves + Angels Defiant -1 to wound vs their high-S rail/fusion) AND you shoot BACK reliably (Interception RepExes, no delivery to strand). Suppress the suits, out-body, and grind — T'au fold in melee if you reach, and your guns punish them if they don't.

Game plan:

- Weather the alpha behind durability; do NOT waste CP on nothing (their AP-4/-5 ignores armour anyway — lean on Angels Defiant + bodies).
- Interception guns delete a Riptide/Crisis brick each turn; SUPPRESS the markerlight Pathfinders + the alpha (-1 to hit).
- Advance the bricks; Sword Brethren crush anything that lingers; hold primary with bodies they can't shift fast enough.

Watch for: Rail/fusion Devastating Wounds spike through saves; spread bricks to limit mortal spillover. A real coin-flip — practise it.

Necrons — Awakened Dynasty (C'tan + Wraiths)

COIN-FLIP · *Prevalence: Med (4)*

Deciding factor: C'tan durability (4+/-1Dmg/reanim) blunts your removal and they out-grind on reanimating bodies; you can't table 3 shards. Your edge: reliable guns + the crit-5 Sword Brethren (Accept vow +1 wound) chip a C'tan, and you out-durable the rest. A grind you steal on objectives.

Game plan:

- Focus ONE C'tan with guns + the Sword Brethren brick (spread chip just reanimates); EC snipes a Technomancer.
- Hold with the relic anvil + bodies; suppress the gauss to cut their return fire.
- Win on sticky primary + secondaries, not on the body-count.

Watch for: Reanimation refunding your chip, and their forced-battle-shock C'tan strat (test at -1 + mortals) hitting a key holder — focus-remove whole units.

Adeptus Custodes — Lions of the Emperor (elite melee)

COIN-FLIP (lean favourable) · *Prevalence: Med (4)*

Deciding factor: Elite mirror you edge on VOLUME + reliability: you have far more bodies, the Interception guns + crit-5 Sword Brethren delete a Caladius/Custodian brick, and the EC's PRECISION Black Sword duels their characters where their own attached chars can't cleanly answer. Angels Defiant + the anvil out-last their few models.

Game plan:

- Guns + Sword Brethren delete a Custodian brick/turn; PIN the Wardens/Blade Champion off your line.
- EMPEROR'S CHAMPION vs their character (Precision + Anti-Character) = a real melee assassination.
- Out-body + hold; they have ~40 models, you have more + the auspex debuffs.

Watch for: Their melee out-damages a single brick head-on; gang two units + pin before you commit.

Blood Angels — Stormlance / Liberator jump alpha

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: Med (4)*

Deciding factor: A glass melee alpha into a durable hold-and-punish army is a good matchup for you: you RECEIVE the charge behind 2+/Angels Defiant + Grimaldus re-roll-hits, overwatch thins the drop, and you counter-punch with a fresh Sword Brethren brick + the EC. They fold once the alpha is spent; you don't.

Game plan:

- Screen so DC/Sang Guard land 9"+ out; gatling + Assault Intercessor overwatch thins them; SUPPRESS the alpha.
- Weather the charge on the anvil (Angels Defiant -1 wound); counter-charge the spent unit with the Sword Brethren + EC on their Priest/Lemartes.
- Out-grind and out-score — you're the durable one here.

Watch for: Getting a key brick charged before it can Angels-Defiant; hold the strat for the swing charge.

Dark Angels — Deathwing Knights / Inner Circle

COIN-FLIP (lean favourable) · *Prevalence: Med (3-4)*

Deciding factor: Terminator mirror decided on primary: your Interception HLDs + the crit-5 Sword Brethren (Lethal auto-wounds SKIP the to-wound roll, grinding the 4++/-1Dmg mace brick better than normal attacks) chew the Deathwing, and you out-body + out-shoot. Both slow -> board position + the sticky anvil decide it.

Game plan:

- Guns + Sword Brethren focus the Deathwing brick (Lethal-on-5 volume beats the 4++); the Lion is a Monster -> shoot him.
- PIN/suppress the mace brick to slow its advance; hold objectives + grind.
- Race primary; your body-count + reliable guns edge the mirror.

Watch for: Feeding a single brick piecemeal into the mace; commit with support + pin first.

Drukhari — Skysplinter Assault (fast splinter + lance)

UNFAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: Med (3)*

Deciding factor: Speed is your kryptonite: they out-manoeuver M6, kite the bricks, dark-lance the RepExes, and flip objectives late. Your armour + Angels Defiant tank the splinter fine and your guns shoot their paper down when they're near your line — but you CAN'T catch them, and a durable slow army loses the tempo game to pure speed.

Game plan:

- Hold a tight castle + the Combi-Lieutenant limpet; make them commit into your bubble (their paper folds if it does).
- Interception guns one-shot Ravagers/Venoms to cut mobility + the lance threat; PIN what you can.
- Zone with screens + the jump squads so they can't backfield-raid; grind the secondaries you can hold.

Watch for: Out-actioned and out-scored by raw speed while the bricks chase air. ~34% — a real underdog game.

Astra Militarum — Steel Hammer superheavy / artillery

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: Low-Med (2)*

Deciding factor: Their tanks are Interception-Strike food (2 Heavy Laser Destroyers re-rolling hits + multi-meltas delete a Russ/superheavy a turn) and their D6-damage guns over-kill your bodies (waste). You out-body the low-model tank line, advance-and-charge into the infantry, and hold.

Game plan:

- Interception RepExes + Sword Brethren delete a Russ/Shadowsword each turn; suppress the artillery.
- Advance the bricks; power-fist Crusaders + Sword Brethren carve the Guard infantry.
- Out-body and out-score once the shooting is tar-pitted in melee.

Watch for: Artillery + Leontus orders chipping the bricks early; screen them to the first melee. Slight favour if you weather T1-2.

APPENDIX — VERIFIED PROFILES (the numbers behind the sim)

reliable guns (Interception Strike, full Hit re-roll)

- **Repulsor Executioner — Heavy Laser Destroyer:** S16 | AP-4 | D(D6+4) | A2 | [HEAVY] — x2; wounds a Knight on 3s. Interception Strike = re-roll ALL hits vs targets near your line.
- **Repulsor Executioner — Heavy Onslaught Gatling:** S6 | AP0 | D1 | A12 | [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] — anti-infantry volume; Dev crits = mortals.
- **Repulsor / Eradicator — Multi-melta:** S9 | AP-4 | D(D6) | [MELTA 2] — close-range AT top-up.

the melee hammer (Sword Brethren brick)

- **Sword Brethren — Master-crafted Power Weapon:** S5 | AP-2 | D2 | A3 | [LETHAL HITS] — crit-on-5 (Marshal) -> auto-wounds; +1 to wound up (Accept vow).
- **Sword Brethren — Thunder Hammer:** S8 | AP-2 | D2 | A3 | [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] — x2; Dev crit-wounds = mortals into tough targets.
- **Marshal — Inspirational Exemplar:** unmodified Hit of 5+ = Critical Hit (its unit) — the crit-5 trigger for Lethal Hits.
- **Emperor's Champion — Black Sword (Strike):** S8 | AP-4 (Blades) | D3 | A6 | [ANTI-CHARACTER 5+, PRECISION] — the character-assassin.

the vow + the control layer

- **Templar Vow — Accept Any Challenge:** melee: +1 to Wound when S <= target's T — helps you wound UP into vehicles/monsters/elites.
- **Bastion strats:** Guided Disruption (pin -2M/-2chg), Shock Bombardment (suppress -1 hit), Angels Defiant (-1 to wound vs S>T), Light of Vengeance (Lethal/Sustained) — the debuff/control toolkit on the auspex scan.